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The Perimeter Followed the Money

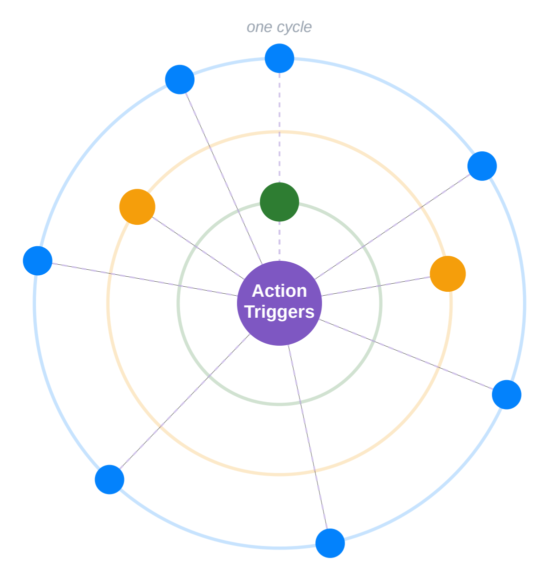
Over this cycle the question was never whether money would leave the bank, but who would follow it. The scans caught the leaving early: dollar stablecoins substituting for local currency, becoming a marginal buyer of Treasury bills, and account-to-account rails acquiring the plumbing to rival cards. Then the perimeter answered, as banks stood up a tokenised-deposit clearing layer, central banks began rationing who may settle, and the rulebooks hardened. The 23 July Decision Intelligence resolved the cycle into one verdict: money is unbundling from the deposit onto programmable rails, and the regulated perimeter is being redrawn around them from both sides at once.

STRATEGIC PICTURE AT A GLANCE

5 Weak signals became measurable	**5** Strategic assumptions changed	**4** Actions now decision-shaped	**1** Strategic constraint replaced

DRAWING ON

- Decision Intelligence, 23 July 2026 · 'The Summer Money Left the Bank'
- Signal Scan, 20 July 2026 · 'Past the Sponsor Bank'
- Change Tracker, 16 July 2026 · 'US and UK stablecoin rulebooks harden as the digital euro clears Parliament'
- Signal Scan, 13 July 2026 · 'The Counter-Ledger'
- Signal Scan, 6 July 2026 · 'The Done-Away Gap'



- Signal Scan, 29 June 2026 · 'The Rail Switch'
- Signal Scan, 22 June 2026 · 'The Stablecoin Bid'
- Change Tracker, 18 June 2026 · 'Bank clearing layer for tokenised deposits arrives as the digital euro nears a vote'
- Signal Scan, 15 June 2026 · 'Liquid Wrapper, Illiquid Core'
- Signal Scan, 8 June 2026 · 'Invisible Dollarisation'

Six weeks of continuous monitoring, resolved into one decision-grade synthesis at the centre.

Early warnings

Signals the portfolio surfaced before consensus formed, in the order they hardened.

LEAD TIME 6 WEEKS AHEAD | SIGNAL SCAN | DECISION INTELLIGENCE

The invisible dollarisation we flagged became the cycle's monetary-transmission spine.

INITIAL SIGNAL

We flagged that dollar stablecoins were driving hard-to-measure currency substitution in vulnerable economies, eroding monetary sovereignty through channels that bypass banking oversight.

NOW EVIDENT

- **IMF and BIS**: a 1% net stablecoin inflow depreciates the local currency about 5-10bp and widens the dollar premium roughly 40bp, moving the channel into the central-bank literature.
- **Flows of 7-8% of GDP** in parts of Latin America, Africa and the Middle East, with 99% of stablecoins dollar-denominated.
- **23 July verdict**: the Decision Intelligence carries stablecoins as a monetary-transmission variable, emerging-market spillovers included, in its Stablecoin Perimeter theme.

EM FLOWS **7-8% of GDP** POSTURE **Prepare**

PREPARE

For the group treasurer and head of policy, stablecoin flows are now a monetary-sovereignty variable in exposed markets, not a crypto-trading curiosity.

LEAD TIME 4 WEEKS AHEAD SIGNAL SCAN DECISION INTELLIGENCE

The stablecoin Treasury bid we flagged became the perimeter's monetary channel.

INITIAL SIGNAL

We flagged that stablecoin reserve backing made dollar tokens a marginal buyer of US Treasury bills, a sovereign-debt market-structure shift rather than a payments story.

NOW EVIDENT

- **BIS, June 2026**: a $3.5bn stablecoin inflow compresses 3-month Treasury-bill yields about 5bp, and 8-10bp during Treasury stress.
- **Standard Chartered**: $0.8-1.0T of fresh Treasury-bill demand by 2028 as the market nears $2T.
- **23 July verdict**: the Decision Intelligence makes the Treasury-bill transmission the spine of its Stablecoin Perimeter theme, with redemptions as the two-way risk.

YIELD IMPACT **~5bp / $3.5bn** POSTURE **Prepare**

PREPARE For the CFO and treasury, the stablecoin-to-Treasury linkage is already operational, so model the exposure and set redemption-stress triggers now.

LEAD TIME 3 WEEKS AHEAD | SIGNAL SCAN | DECISION INTELLIGENCE

The rail switch we flagged reframed the payments contest the DI now calls the identity layer.

INITIAL SIGNAL

We flagged that account-to-account payments were acquiring the scheme-level plumbing they always lacked, the missing precondition to challenge card networks, forming before interchange repricing.

NOW EVIDENT

- **Instant transfers reached almost 34%** of euro-area credit-transfer volume by late 2025.
- **The card networks went rail-neutral**: Mastercard's Agent Pay settles across cards, accounts and stablecoins and it agreed to buy BVNK for up to $1.8bn; Visa aligned with x402.
- **23 July verdict**: the Decision Intelligence's Identity Layer theme places the value on agent identity and mandate verification, not the settlement rail.

A2A SHARE **~34% of euro transfers** POSTURE **Prepare**

PREPARE

For the chief payments and product officer, the settlement rail is commoditising, so the position to stake is in agent identity and mandate verification.

LEAD TIME 10 DAYS AHEAD | SIGNAL SCAN | CHANGE TRACKER | DECISION INTELLIGENCE

The counter-ledger we flagged, banks building money inside the perimeter, became the deposit-defence.

INITIAL SIGNAL

We flagged that regulated institutions, central banks, the BIS and major US banks, were coordinating to build tokenised money inside the banking system rather than resisting tokenisation.

NOW EVIDENT

- **A shared US tokenised-deposit network** from JPMorgan, Bank of America and Citi, via The Clearing House, targeted for H1 2027.
- **Project Agora** moved to real-value testing of tokenised deposits and reserves; the 16 July tracker graded the interbank clearing layer 'emerging'.
- **23 July verdict**: the Decision Intelligence names the tokenised-deposit network as the banks' answer to stablecoin deposit flight.

NETWORK LIVE **H1 2027** POSTURE **Prepare**

PREPARE For the CFO and group treasurer, the banks' answer is a build, not a veto, so the decision is whether to issue, join the consortium or partner.

LEAD TIME 3 DAYS AHEAD | SIGNAL SCAN | DECISION INTELLIGENCE

The settlement-access tiering we flagged set the sovereign-split agenda.

INITIAL SIGNAL

We flagged that the Fed, the Bank of England and the ECB were building tiered direct-settlement-access frameworks, shifting gatekeeping power from sponsor banks to central authorities.

NOW EVIDENT

- **Direct-access eligibility** is being redefined around who may settle in central-bank money without a sponsor bank.
- **Wholesale rails bifurcated** into non-interoperable blocs (BIS Agora versus mBridge), with zero shared members.
- **23 July verdict**: the Decision Intelligence's Sovereign Split theme frames central-bank money dividing over remuneration and access, not over whether a retail CBDC exists.

STABLECOINS VS DEPOSITS **~$315bn vs ~$8tn** POSTURE **Prepare**

PREPARE For the head of policy and treasury, settlement-access terms finalising this cycle will decide who can settle independently over the next 12-24 months.

Assumption changes since the May scan

Cycle-over-cycle assumption changes, in decreasing order of strategic weight.

SHIFT 1 OF 5

"Stablecoins are a payments story"

PRIOR CYCLE HELD

The prior cycle framed stablecoins mainly as a cheaper, faster payments rail and a crypto-settlement instrument.

THIS CYCLE READS

The cycle reframed them as a monetary-transmission and sovereign-debt story: a marginal buyer of Treasury bills whose inflows move front-end yields, and a currency-substitution channel that erodes emerging-market sovereignty.

FORWARD THESIS

The fragile variable next cycle is the CLARITY yield rule, which sets whether the deposit migration is orderly or fast.

SHIFT 2 OF 5

"The banks will resist tokenisation"

PRIOR CYCLE HELD

The prior cycle assumed incumbent banks would defend deposits by slowing tokenisation and lobbying against stablecoins.

THIS CYCLE READS

The banks are building tokenised money inside the perimeter instead: a shared US tokenised-deposit clearing layer for H1 2027 and coordinated central-bank and commercial-bank rails, the counter-ledger.

FORWARD THESIS

Watch the Clearing House go-live and Agora's first real-value transaction, and the decision on network membership, custody and treasury policy.

SHIFT 3 OF 5

"The card rail is the moat"

PRIOR CYCLE HELD

The prior cycle treated the card networks' settlement rail as the durable competitive moat in payments.

THIS CYCLE READS

The networks conceded rail-neutrality, settling across cards, accounts and stablecoins, and moved the contest up to agent identity and mandate verification, while account-to-account rails acquired scheme-level plumbing.

FORWARD THESIS

The variables to watch are which agentic-payment standard wins (AP2, ACP or x402) and whether value accrues to the network or the AI platform that owns the consumer relationship.

SHIFT 4 OF 5

"Retail CBDC is the sovereign question"

PRIOR CYCLE HELD

The prior cycle framed the sovereign-money question as whether and when a retail central bank digital currency would launch.

THIS CYCLE READS

The US legislated a four-year retail-CBDC ban with a wholesale carve-out, China's e-CNY went interest-bearing, and central banks began rationing direct settlement access, so the real sovereign question became remuneration and access, not a retail digital dollar.

FORWARD THESIS

Watch the digital-euro remuneration and holding cap, e-CNY cross-border use, and which institutions win direct settlement access.

SHIFT 5 OF 5

"Deposit migration is a slow, compositional drift"

PRIOR CYCLE HELD

The prior cycle assumed money would leave the bank only slowly, as a benign compositional reallocation the system absorbs.

THIS CYCLE READS

The pace became a policy variable: the BPI models up to $3.7tn of deposit loss if stablecoin yield is allowed, money-market funds hit a record $8.3tn, and retailised private credit already moved a liquidity mismatch onto households.

FORWARD THESIS

The forward triggers are the CLARITY yield text and the first redemption stress in a retail private-credit wrapper.

Actions triggered

Each trigger names why it activates now, why it matters, the recommended actions, the primary decision owner, the decision window, and the conditions under which the recommendation should be reviewed.

DECIDE ACTION 1 SIGNAL SCAN DECISION INTELLIGENCE

Set the deposit-defence posture and the tokenised-deposit play now, before the yield rule lands.

TRIGGER CONDITION

This recommendation is activated because GENIUS put stablecoins inside the regulated line, because the Bank Policy Institute models up to $3.7tn of deposit loss if yield is permitted, and because the largest banks are already building a shared tokenised-deposit network for H1 2027.

PRIMARY DECISION OWNER **CFO / Group Treasurer**

DECISION WINDOW IMMEDIATE **Before the CLARITY yield rule (Q4 2026)**

WHY THIS NOW MATTERS

The deposit base is being contested from three sides at once, stablecoins, money-market funds at a record $8.3tn, and tokenised deposits, and the still-unwritten yield rule sets the pace.

WHO GAINS

The advantage accrues to tokenised-deposit consortia and the banks that move first on compliant on-chain settlement, and to the issuers, such as Circle, that win bank distribution.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- **Immediate:** run deposit-flight scenarios keyed to the CLARITY yield outcome and set deposit-beta assumptions accordingly.
- **Immediate:** decide the tokenised-deposit posture, whether to issue, join the consortium or partner with an issuer.
- **Follow-on:** stage the commitment against the Clearing House go-live so it is not stranded if yield is banned.

REVIEW CONDITIONS

This recommendation should be reviewed if the CLARITY yield provision is banned or narrowly capped, or if stablecoin market cap stalls near current levels without deposit outflow.

PREPARE ACTION 2 SIGNAL SCAN DECISION INTELLIGENCE

Stake a position in the agent-identity and mandate layer before the standards harden.

TRIGGER CONDITION

This recommendation is activated because the card networks conceded rail-neutrality, because account-to-account rails acquired the plumbing to rival cards, and because the agentic-payment standards (AP2, ACP, x402) are consolidating fast.

PRIMARY DECISION OWNER **Chief Payments / Product Officer**

DECISION WINDOW PREPARE **Before standards consolidate (end-2026)**

WHY THIS NOW MATTERS

The value in payments is migrating from owning the settlement rail to owning agent identity and mandate verification, and the window to position is before a few incumbents lock the stack.

WHO GAINS

The advantage accrues to identity and credentialing providers, mandate-verification integrators, and the stablecoin settlement rails such as Coinbase, Stripe and BVNK.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- **Immediate:** choose and pilot an agentic-payment stack (AP2, ACP or x402) and define the firm's identity and mandate role.
- **Immediate:** map exposure to interchange repricing as account-to-account volume scales.
- **Follow-on:** hedge by owning the consumer or merchant relationship rather than betting on a single protocol.

REVIEW CONDITIONS

This recommendation should be reviewed if agent identity standardises on an open protocol any wallet can implement, or if a major merchant routes agent payments off-card by default.

DECIDE ACTION 3 SIGNAL SCAN DECISION INTELLIGENCE

Build for atomic, around-the-clock settlement and meet the Treasury-clearing deadline.

TRIGGER CONDITION

This recommendation is activated because DTCC brings tokenisation to production in October 2026, because the US Treasury-clearing mandate's cash deadline lands in December 2026 before the multi-CCP market structure it assumes exists, and because the IMF warns automated margin calls can accelerate selloffs.

PRIMARY DECISION OWNER **COO / Head of Markets**

DECISION WINDOW IMMEDIATE **Treasury-clearing cash deadline, December 2026**

WHY THIS NOW MATTERS

Tokenised settlement is moving from pilot to production while the Treasury-clearing big bang concentrates into a done-with model via FICC, so deferring the operating-model decision defaults the firm into the concentrated outcome.

WHO GAINS

The advantage accrues to tokenisation infrastructure such as DTCC and Canton, the CCPs and sponsored-repo providers holding the concentrated flow, and collateral-mobility and risk-analytics vendors.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- **Immediate:** confirm the Treasury-clearing access model (done-with FICC versus done-away) ahead of the December 2026 cash deadline.
- **Follow-on:** define a tokenised-settlement operating-model roadmap for atomic, 24/7 settlement and collateral mobility.
- **Follow-on:** add a machine-speed, correlated-liquidity stress scenario to fund and treasury risk models.

REVIEW CONDITIONS

This recommendation should be reviewed if the clearing deadline is deferred, or if tokenised-market scale stays small enough that the reflexivity risk is confirmed as a 2028-plus concern.

MONITOR ACTION 4 DECISION INTELLIGENCE SIGNAL SCAN

Monitor the sovereign split, settlement-access tiering and the dollar-to-gold shift, and position reserves and rails.

TRIGGER CONDITION

This recommendation is activated because the US legislated a retail-CBDC ban with a wholesale carve-out, because China's e-CNY went interest-bearing, because central banks began rationing direct settlement access, and because the dollar's reserve share fell below 57%, migrating into gold.

PRIMARY DECISION OWNER **Group Treasurer / Head of Policy**

DECISION WINDOW MONITOR **Next cycle, with named checkpoints**

WHY THIS NOW MATTERS

The sovereign-money system is fragmenting over remuneration and access rather than over whether a retail CBDC exists, and the dollar is ceding store-of-value share to gold while keeping trade dominance.

WHO GAINS

The advantage accrues to wholesale-rail and correspondent-alternative providers, gold and reserve-diversification managers, and the dollar-stablecoin issuers extending the dollar's reach onto new rails.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- **Immediate:** stand up a watch on the digital-euro cap and remuneration stance, e-CNY cross-border pilots and official gold flows.
- **Follow-on:** position payment rails and reserve exposure for a multi-bloc settlement world.
- **Follow-on:** track direct-settlement-access eligibility for the firm and its counterparties.

REVIEW CONDITIONS

This recommendation should be reviewed if a second major economy adopts a remunerated retail CBDC, or if a major reserve manager publicly rebalances further from Treasuries into gold.

The body of work, in one sentence

Over this cycle the binding question stopped being whether money would leave the bank deposit and became who would follow it there: the scans caught the leaving early, dollar stablecoins substituting for local money, becoming a marginal buyer of Treasury bills, and account-to-account rails acquiring the plumbing to rival cards, while the perimeter answered by standing up a tokenised-deposit clearing layer, rationing who may settle in central-bank money, and hardening the rulebooks, so the plan should now be underwritten against a system where money is programmable, the regulated line is being redrawn around it from both sides, and the still-unwritten stablecoin yield rule is the single switch that sets the pace.

This briefing is not another report. It is the synthesis produced after continuously monitoring signals, tracking change, testing assumptions and updating scenarios throughout the cycle on **Financial Services & Future of Money**. Its purpose is to identify the points at which accumulated evidence has become decision-changing: the early warnings the work caught before consensus formed, the assumptions that have shifted between cycles, and the actions now decision-shaped enough to act on. Continuous intelligence on this topic is available as a Single-Topic or Multi-Topic programme.

Discuss a Tailored Programme

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